



MONTHLY UPDATE

Regional collaboration: monthly update, July 2026

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38 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

Algeria [signed as a founding member of a world artificial-intelligence organisation at Shanghai on 16 July](#), the digitalisation commissioner stating an intention to take an active role. The organisation is not named in anything held, and no accord text, ratification step or work programme is on file.

Benin

The customs administrations of Nigeria, Cameroon and Benin [adopted a joint communiqué on 27 July establishing a trilateral steering committee](#) to apply a southern African border-modernisation model to the Sèmè-Kraké and Mfum-Ekok corridors, after a benchmarking mission whose technical team included two named private suppliers alongside the three administrations. Separately, the cross-border digital identity work Benin does through Smart Africa moved from development into a running pilot: [an identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two](#), with eighteen further countries said to be joining and no date given for any of them.

Benin [co-leads a six-country francophone West African framework on artificial-intelligence governance](#), taken to the United Nations global dialogue on 9 July. The framework is in development and no text, timetable or commitment is held.

Botswana

The [ICT memorandum with Namibia was signed at Kasane on 7 August](#) between the two ICT ministries, with their operators and regulators present, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development. It had been [announced for signature the day before](#) as an extension of existing roaming and submarine-cable transit cooperation. The signed instrument itself is not held, and no term, funding or data-governance provision is published; what the two sides did publish alongside it is operational, and is recorded under connectivity below.

Burundi

Vietnam's science and technology ministry [received Burundi's governing-party secretary-general on 28 July 2026 and pressed for faster implementation of the November 2024 memorandum](#). The channel runs through the party rather than the ministry. Vietnam asked Burundi to create conditions for Lumitel, its own operator's subsidiary, to contribute more; Burundi named postal-system modernisation and internet infrastructure as its priorities. No monetary commitment was announced.

Central African Republic

The regional central bank and the payments body [launched an interoperable QR-code standard at Douala on 29 July under an April 2026 regulation](#), binding across the six member states, routed and settled through the regional switch and secured to card-industry standards. [The country's share of regional payment volume was 0.43% in 2024 – the smallest but one, against the largest member state's 65.10% – and no country-specific adoption step is on file](#). The regional report holds no value figure or account count for the country, so what the standard reaches here cannot be sized.

Comoros

Comoros was named among the seven states covered by the [Programme for African Developing Island Economies, which AUDA-NEPAD launched at the Ministerial Segment of the Specialized Technical Committee on Trade, Industry and Minerals in Abidjan on 24 July 2026](#). The 2026–2031 roadmap organises support around six pillars, including connectivity and AfCFTA integration and digital transformation, with digital public infrastructure, artificial intelligence and automation named among the accelerators. Ministers adopted a communiqué committing to the programme, advanced in partnership with the Republic of Korea, the African Development Bank, the regional economic communities and the Indian Ocean Commission. No Comorian component, financing figure or national milestone was stated.

Congo

Namibia's cabinet [approved an ICT cooperation memorandum and authorised its minister to sign](#); no Congolese source, approval step or text is held.

DR Congo

The [African Telecommunications Union's return to Kinshasa was ratified on 23 July at the union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja, after the country paid more than US\\$1.4m in arrears](#). No date for the move is stated, the arrears figure and the account are the minister's own, and a bid for a seat on the ITU's administrative council for 2027 to 2030 is still pending.

Egypt

Egypt took the chairmanship of two Arab working groups on 31 July 2026 — AI governance, whose remit is a guidance framework and mechanisms for activating the Arab Charter for AI Ethics, and quantum computing, whose remit is an Arab quantum strategy and quantum-cybersecurity deployment. The committee was created by an Arab ministerial resolution at a session Egypt hosted in January 2026 and held its first founding meeting at the ICT ministry in May ([election account](#)).

Equatorial Guinea

The Minister of Foreign Affairs [signed the Malabo Convention at Addis Ababa on 28 July 2026](#), on the margins of the 49th Ordinary Session of the Executive Council. The AU status list as of 2 February 2026 recorded no signature, no ratification and no deposit for Equatorial Guinea, so the Chamber of Deputies' vote of 25 March 2026 was a domestic authorisation to ratify taken before the country was a signatory; no instrument of ratification is on file.

Ethiopia

The regional transit corridor moved from agreement to build. Ethio telecom [entered active deployment of the Horizon Fiber Initiative, with end-to-end solution architecture finalised and site-material procurement complete](#), on a multi-terabit terrestrial route linking Djibouti's subsea landings through Ethiopia and Sudan to Jeddah. No route length, capacity, cost, in-service date or transit-revenue projection is published, so the regional-hub claim rests on the geography alone — and one of the four territories the route crosses is at war.

Gabon

On 31 July the ministry's final technical committee of the administrative year named its next-cycle workstreams, among them a candidacy for International Telecommunication Union governance bodies, with no body, seat or election date named ([review](#)).

Gambia

The revenue authority [hosted the seventh ATAF Heads of Tax Administrations Master Class in Banjul on 23-24 July 2026](#). The Forum's executive secretary argued from Rwanda, Kenya and Morocco that digital systems deliver only alongside governance reform — "technology alone collects nothing" — and [pressed for a united African position at the United Nations](#).

Ghana

Ghana's regional position moved on three fronts, none of them with a text attached. African Union ministers [endorsed continental roll-out of the illicit-financial-flows policy tracker](#) from the six-country pilot Ghana ran over eighteen months, the finance ministry reporting that it contributed to recovering millions of dollars in revenue — with no Ghana-specific score, finding or reform list published. The communications ministry [announced a partnership on digital-policy intelligence and regulatory-analysis tools](#) at an Accra workshop on 10 August, covering the national AI strategy, data-governance work and the coders programme, with no funding, duration or deliverables

stated. And the [fintech licence passporting memorandum with Rwanda remains unpublished by either central bank](#) eighteen months after signature, so which licence categories are recognised, and on what conditions, is still unestablished.

A fourth front does have something running. A continental alliance and a German development agency say [a digital identity issued in Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining](#). No scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated.

Guinea-Bissau

[AUDA-NEPAD launched the Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#) at the Ministerial Segment of the Specialized Technical Committee on Trade, Industry and Minerals in Abidjan on 24 July 2026, covering Guinea-Bissau alongside Cabo Verde, the Comoros, Madagascar, Mauritius, Sao Tome and Principe and Seychelles. A 2026–2031 roadmap groups the seven states under six pillars, including connectivity and AfCFTA integration and digital transformation — with digital public infrastructure, artificial intelligence and automation named as accelerators. Ministers adopted a communique committing to the programme; no Guinea-Bissau-specific national action under it has yet been reported.

Kenya

The continental data convention still has no Kenyan signature behind it. A peer-reviewed review of health-data governance in four countries [records only Rwanda as a signatory and finds all four frameworks fragmented, with weak harmonisation of cross-border transfers and capacity gaps](#). That is a finding about the record rather than a change in it: nothing establishes a position either way, and the row is carried as a dated absence.

Liberia

At the African Telecommunications Union plenipotentiary session in Abuja in July, Liberia [negotiated a waiver of US\\$361,151.36 in arrears dating back to 1982, deposited its instrument of ratification and had its voting rights restored](#).

Libya

On 26 July a delegation from the communications authority [attended the African Telecommunications Union's 7th Plenipotentiary Conference in Abuja](#) and held bilateral meetings to seek support for Libya's candidacy for membership of the ITU Council.

On 1 August the executive bureau of the Council of Arab Ministers of Communications and Information, meeting in Tunisia, [recorded Libya as chair of the Arab working group on AI Data and Digital Infrastructure](#), one of six groups under the Arab Permanent Committee on Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technologies.

On 15 August, on the margins of ARABOSAI's fiftieth-anniversary ceremony in Amman, Libya's Audit Bureau and Tunisia's Court of Auditors [signed a roadmap to activate an existing cooperation agreement](#), covering exchange of expertise, capacity building, development of digital systems and solutions, and cooperation on artificial intelligence and its governance. No phase dates, budget or workplan is published.

Madagascar

Madagascar attached itself to three external arrangements in twelve days, none of which it wrote. The Council of Ministers [approved joining a China-initiated international network against cybercrime on 4 August](#), mobilising the foreign affairs, justice, public-security, digital-development and gendarmerie ministries for cross-border cooperation on online fraud; no founding text, membership list, data-sharing rule or safeguard on what is exchanged is held. Around 15 August it also [signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime and joined the World AI Cooperation Organization](#), the account citing Interpol findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity. An [editorial the same week](#) frames the turn toward Beijing on fraud as inseparable from the country's digital-transformation and investment ambitions. None of the three is evidenced by an instrument the base holds, and the country still has no national artificial-intelligence strategy of its own.

Malawi

The regulator and UNDP [named priorities in exploratory discussions — national identity integration with SIM verification, responsible artificial intelligence, stronger data protection and secondary-school digital skills drawing on the universal service fund](#). No memorandum, funding figure or timetable is stated.

Mali

On 24 July Mali was [re-elected to the African Telecommunications Union board for 2027-2031](#) at the Abuja plenipotentiary.

The same 1 August recommendations also included [a protocol between AES states to harmonise AI governance](#).

Mauritius

The continental internet registry seated here is still without a settled board. One outlet's analysis records that the registry [named a person to all eight board seats on 12 September 2025 while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised](#), and that the appeal court has now [set aside its 2023 appeal for want of corporate authority without ruling on the official receiver's permission or on statutory leave](#). The chain from election through appointment to quorum is therefore unresolved and the receiver undischarged. No registry statement on the withheld tallies is held.

Morocco

Morocco was elected to the African Telecommunications Union's Administrative Council for 2027-2031 at the union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja on 25 July, with a delegation combining the digital ministry, the regulator and the development agency ([ministry communique](#)).

Namibia

Cabinet approved a memorandum on information technology cooperation with the Republic of Congo at its 22nd and 23rd sittings and authorised the minister to sign, publishing no scope, sector detail, financing or signature date ([cabinet account](#)).

Namibia joined four other governments as a founding partner of a pan-African African-language artificial-intelligence initiative launched at a continental telecommunications conference in Abuja on 24 July ([launch account](#)). Namibia's stated commitment is ministerial support rather than a named contribution, and the ICT minister is one of eight Africans on a 44-member international commission ([conference account](#)).

The memorandum with Botswana was signed. The two ICT ministries, with their operators and regulators, [signed at Kasane on 7 August, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development](#), and published operational detail alongside it: [the Trans-Kalahari Corridor's remaining 4G gaps costed at about N\\$52 million across 13 new sites, and the Gobabis-Buitepos fibre link completed and interconnecting with the Botswana backbone company at Charles Hill](#) — the first direct cross-border fibre link between the two operators — with the two incident-response teams said to be deepening cooperation. The signed instrument itself is not held, and no term, funding or data-governance provision is published.

India is the other bilateral track. At the [fourth joint trade committee in New Delhi on 12 August the two governments advanced cybersecurity and digital-economy cooperation](#), building on a memorandum the two heads of government signed in July 2025 and against bilateral trade put at more than US\$592m in 2025/26. That memorandum's text is not held either.

The regulator also took the chair of something. The southern African regulators' association [opened the first meeting of its legal and policy committee at Windhoek from 10 to 12 August, with artificial-intelligence governance, data governance and protection, digital public infrastructure and regulatory harmonisation on the agenda](#). No work programme, output or timetable is published with it.

Niger

On 30 July a Nigerien technical mission led by the interior ministry's secretary-general was [received in Ouagadougou to study Burkina Faso's identification machinery](#) — the civil-status modernisation directorate, the national identification office, the ICT agency and the WURI project. The delegation covered civil registration, migration, the digital agency, territorial surveillance, biometric-card production, the interior ministry's legal service and the ICT and finance ministries, and reported recommendations on issuing authentic documents and limiting document fraud.

Nigeria

[Nigeria, Kenya and Morocco are the first pilots](#) for shared cross-border rails for identity, payments and trusted data exchange, and [the country implementation forum was inaugurated in Abuja on 29 July](#).

Ministers adopted an Abuja declaration on meaningful connectivity.

The continental data convention still has no Nigerian signature behind it: a peer-reviewed review of health-data governance in four countries [records only Rwanda as a signatory, and finds all four frameworks fragmented with weak harmonisation of cross-border transfers](#). That is a finding about the record, carried as a dated absence.

Rwanda

Country consultations for a [regional artificial-intelligence framework](#) were held at Kigali on 3 August, to feed a study toward a regional strategy, model policy guidelines and model regulatory frameworks; no text or timetable is published, and Rwanda reported unquantified progress on its own national policy. The [bilateral licence passporting memorandum with Ghana remains unpublished by either central bank](#) eighteen months after signature, cited as a working precedent with no firm reported as having used it.

One piece of regional machinery moved from design into use. A continental alliance and a German development agency say [a digital identity issued in Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now being recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining](#). No scale, service, date or governing instrument is stated for any of it.

Sao Tome and Principe

São Tomé and Príncipe was one of six countries at the [second Lusophone Africa data governance workshop, held in Luanda from 15 to 17 June with an implementation focus — data centres, cloud, interoperability, digital public infrastructure and institutional governance](#). No São Toméan national content from the workshop is detailed, so what the country took from it is not established.

Senegal

Regionally, Senegal became [one of 29 founding states of an intergovernmental AI-governance body on 16 July](#), and joined the approval on 31 July of [three ECOWAS statistical methodological guides](#).

Seychelles

AUDA-NEPAD launched its [Programme for African Developing Island Economies at the AU's STC Ministerial Segment in Abidjan on 24 July 2026](#), adopting a ministerial communique covering seven island states including Seychelles on a 2026–2031 roadmap that names digital transformation one of six pillars, alongside partners Korea, AfDB, the regional economic communities and the Indian Ocean Commission.

Sierra Leone

Regional health data gained an institutional seat. The health minister [attended the inaugural board meeting of the Health Intelligence Centres for Africa in Addis Ababa with the head of the national health information hub, Sierra Leone being a founding member and sitting on the strategic advisory board](#). Founding membership is a position the base can state; what it cannot yet state is what the body will do with member states' health data, since no constitutive instrument, budget or data-sharing arrangement is published.

Somalia

The connection to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System is [a target for before the end of 2026 rather than a concluded arrangement](#).

South Sudan

The one regional move in the window is a pledge without a workplan. On 12 August the minister [visited the African Telecommunications Union's Nairobi headquarters and pledged deeper collaboration on infrastructure, capacity building and standardisation](#). No workplan, contribution or membership status is stated, and it sits alongside the payment-system bill validated the same month with East African Community and Bank of Uganda backing — the substantive regional support in this record runs through that bill rather than through the union.

Togo

The corridor the country sits on is the subject of the month's regional work. A [regional dialogue at the Togo-Ghana joint border post on 13 August sought to accelerate free movement along the Abidjan-Lagos corridor, reaffirming rollout of the regional biometric identity card and the interconnected transit system to cut border delays](#). No deployment figure, timetable or data-protection arrangement for the shared border and transit data is stated, and the reaffirmation is of commitments the base has held for some time rather than of anything newly delivered.

Tunisia

Tunisia took a [2027-2030 seat on the African Telecommunications Union's administrative council on 24 July 2026](#), giving it a vote on continental direction across digital transformation, artificial intelligence and cybersecurity. What it intends to press for is not reported.

A [Japanese-financed triangular programme was signed](#), reported 28 July 2026, to run 2026-2028 with the communication technologies ministry and the national technopark operator, convening African participants in Tunis on how startup support systems are built and run; the first session in December 2026 takes eight countries. No amount is disclosed.

Uganda

Uganda was [elected to the African Telecommunications Union Administrative Council at Abuja on 24 July](#), one of 25 member states for a four-year term. At a regional central bankers' meeting in Kampala the same day, the chair called for a [harmonised East African framework for regulatory sandboxes covering artificial intelligence and digital finance](#); the meeting's signed communiqué records no such item.

Zambia

A [Zambian was elected Secretary-General of the African Telecommunications Union at Abuja on the fourth round with 21 of 34 votes](#), taking office on 1 January 2027 for four years — while Zambia was not elected to the 25-member administrative council for the coming cycle, gaining the continental secretariat and losing the council seat together. Separately a [regional central bank spokesperson said four states including Zambia are considering](#)

onboarding their currencies to the regional settlement system, potentially by end-2027; nothing establishes that the Bank of Zambia has decided, and the electronic clearing house is separately reported as not yet live on the regional instant-payment scheme.

Zimbabwe

A Rwandan immigration delegation toured two border posts on 29 July under a 2024 bilateral memorandum ([visit account](#)).

Harare then hosted the regional attempt to write common rules for the thing all these systems run on. Southern African regulators, data-protection authorities and artificial-intelligence task forces [met for a three-day workshop to harmonise national data-governance rules](#), anchored to the African Union data policy framework, a continental data governance blueprint, the regional data strategy and a UNESCO toolkit, with the convening body noting that only 1% of data-centre capacity sits within Africa. No outcome document, commitment or timetable from it is held.

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